BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

My tests and treatment checks

Routine safety tests, symptom-driven tests and response scans have different purposes.

Check	Before starting	Treatment visits	Between visits	Next cycle / phase	After treatment
Blood and organ checks	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms.	Full blood count before each treatment; kidney and liver blood tests before each cycle.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and earlier toxicity before another dose.	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.
Treatment and appointments	Confirm the complete treatment plan.	Gemcitabine is given into a vein over 30 minutes on Days 1 and 8. Checks, preparation and observation add to the time in the unit.	Follow written medicine and contact instructions.	The team reviews symptoms, side effects and response. Treatment may finish earlier if it is no longer helping or causes unacceptable problems.	Record completion and the named follow-up team.
Mouth, weight and swallowing	Assess symptoms, teeth, eating and drinking.	Review weight, intake and mouth symptoms.	Call for difficulty swallowing, worsening pain or weight loss.	Dietitian and swallowing support according to need.	Continue rehabilitation and dental care if advised.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00514 v3: retrieved official regimen

Tests in your plan

Full blood count

WHEN

Before each treatment.

Checks infection-fighting cells, oxygen-carrying cells and platelets for clotting.

Kidney and liver tests

WHEN

Full blood count before each treatment; kidney and liver blood tests before each cycle.

Checks treatment handling and organ safety.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Gemcitabine alone: nasopharyngeal cancer: treatment and checks

Recurrent or metastatic nasopharyngeal cancer that cannot be treated with local treatment aimed at cure.

Gemcitabine 1,250 mg/m^2 on Days 1 and 8 every 21 days, for up to 6 cycles or until progression or unacceptable side effects.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Treatment visits	Between visits	Next cycle / phase	After treatment
Blood and organ checks NCCP	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms.	Full blood count before each treatment; kidney and liver blood tests before each cycle.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and earlier toxicity before another dose.	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.
Treatment and appointments NCCP	Confirm the complete treatment plan.	Gemcitabine is given into a vein over 30 minutes on Days 1 and 8. Checks, preparation and observation add to the time in the unit.	Follow written medicine and contact instructions.	The team reviews symptoms, side effects and response. Treatment may finish earlier if it is no longer helping or causes unacceptable problems.	Record completion and the named follow-up team.
Mouth, weight and swallowing NCCP	Assess symptoms, teeth, eating and drinking.	Review weight, intake and mouth symptoms.	Call for difficulty swallowing, worsening pain or weight loss.	Dietitian and swallowing support according to need.	Continue rehabilitation and dental care if advised.

What each check is for

1 Treatment course

Days 1 and 8; every 21 days; up to 6 cycles.

Gemcitabine is used to control the cancer and relieve symptoms. Your team discusses expected benefit, alternatives and when to review whether treatment is helping.

Ask / act: Confirm active medicines, safety checks and support plan.

Sources: NCCP

2 Review / next phase

After the planned course and recovery review

Review response and recovery.

Ask / act: Confirm actual dates and the next prescription.

Sources: NCCP

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-11 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.49